

Word family: **honest / honestly / honesty / dishonest / dishonestly / dishonesty**

Base word: honest

Part of speech: **adjective**

Related forms:

* **honestly** (adv.) — 誠實地；坦白說；真的

* **honesty** (n.) — 誠實；坦率

* **dishonest** (adj.) — 不誠實的；欺騙的

* **dishonestly** (adv.) — 不誠實地

* **dishonesty** (n.) — 不誠實；欺騙行為

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **honest person**

* **be honest with someone**

* **be honest about something**

* **honest answer / opinion**

* **honest mistake**

* **honest work / living**

* **to be honest**

* **to be perfectly/completely honest**

* **honestly speaking**

* **honestly think / believe**

* **honest with yourself**

* **in all honesty**

* **honest-to-goodness** *(informal)*

Meaning in this passage

> Looking ahead, I **honestly think** he will grow into a very creative person.

Here, **honestly** does **not primarily mean** “without lying.”

It functions as a **stance adverb**, emphasizing that the speaker **genuinely and sincerely believes** what follows.

honestly think = 真心認為；真的認為；坦白說，我認為

中文翻譯：

展望未來，我**真的 / 真心覺得**他會成長為一個很有創意的人。

So here:

honestly = genuinely; sincerely — 真心地；確實地

1. **honest (人：誠實的) — 誠實的；老實的**

This is the core adjective meaning.

Practice 1

> She is an **honest** person.

她是一個很**誠實的人**。

Practice 2

> I trust him because he has always been **honest** with me.

我信任他，因為他一直對我很**坦誠**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****honest = 不說謊、不欺騙，而且願意說出真實情況的****

2. **be honest with someone — 對某人坦白；誠實相待**

Practice 1

> Please **be honest with me**.

請**對我坦白**。

Practice 2

> She was completely **honest with her parents** about what happened.

她對父母完全**坦白交代**了事情的經過。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be honest with someone = 對某人說真話，不故意隱瞞或欺騙****

3. **be honest about something — 坦白談及某事**

Practice 1

> He was **honest about his mistakes**.

他對自己的錯誤很**坦白**。

Practice 2

> We need to be **honest about the difficulties** we face.

我們需要**坦誠面對 / 談及**目前的困難。

MCQ-ready definition:

be honest about something = 對某件事如實說明，不隱瞞真相

4. **honest answer — 誠實的回答；真實想法**

Practice 1

> Give me an **honest answer**.

給我一個**誠實的回答**。

Practice 2

> I want your **honest opinion**.

我想聽你的**真實意見**。

MCQ-ready definition:

honest answer/opinion = 真正反映說話者所知道、所相信或所感受的回答 / 意見

5. **honest criticism / feedback — 坦率真誠的批評 / 意見**

Practice 1

> I appreciate your **honest feedback**.

我很感激你**坦率而真誠的意見**。

Practice 2

> Sometimes we need **honest criticism** to improve.

有時候我們需要**坦誠的批評**才能進步。

MCQ-ready definition:

honest feedback/criticism = 不因怕得罪對方而掩飾真實看法的意見

6. **honest mistake** — 無心之失；真心犯下的錯誤

This does **not** mean “a truthful mistake.”

It means the person made the mistake genuinely, without cheating or bad intentions.

Practice 1

> It was an **honest mistake**.

那只是一次**無心之失**。

Practice 2

> She gave me the wrong number, but it was an **honest mistake**.

她給錯了我號碼，但那只是**無心犯的錯誤**。

MCQ-ready definition:

honest mistake = 並非故意欺騙、傷害或做錯，而是真正不小心造成的錯誤

7. **honest work / honest living** — 正當工作 / 正當生活

Here **honest** means lawful, legitimate, and not based on cheating.

Practice 1

> He earns his money through **honest work**.

他靠**正當工作**賺錢。

Practice 2

> She wanted to make an **honest living**.

她希望靠**正當方式謀生**。

MCQ-ready definition:

honest work/living = 合法、正當、不靠欺騙或犯罪的工作 / 謀生方式

8. **honest value / price / deal** — 公道的；不欺騙人的

Less central, but established.

Practice 1

> They offer good products at an **honest price**.

他們以**公道的價格**出售優質產品。

Practice 2

> We just want an **honest deal**.

我們只想要一宗**公平、不欺騙人的交易**。

MCQ-ready definition:

honest price/deal = 公平合理、不涉及欺騙或隱藏手段的價格 / 交易

9. **honestly** (誠實地) — 誠實地；如實地

This is the straightforward adverbial form.

Practice 1

> Please answer **honestly**.

請**誠實地**回答。

Practice 2

> She **honestly admitted** that she had made a mistake.

她**坦白承認**自己犯了錯。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****honestly = 不說謊、不隱瞞地****

10. ****honestly think / believe — 真心認為；真的相信****

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> I ****honestly think**** he will grow into a very creative person.

我****真的 / 真心認為****他會成長為一個很有創意的人。

Practice 2

> I ****honestly believe**** she did her best.

我****真心相信****她已經盡了全力。

Practice 3

> I ****honestly think**** this is the best solution.

我****真的認為****這是最好的解決方法。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****honestly + think/believe = 真誠地、確實地持有某個看法或信念****

11. ****to be honest — 老實說；坦白說****

A very common discourse expression.

Practice 1

> ****To be honest****, I'm a little tired.

****老實說****，我有點累。

Practice 2

> ****To be honest****, I didn't enjoy the film very much.

****坦白說****，我不太喜歡那部電影。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****to be honest = 用來引出說話者真正、坦率的想法或感受****

12. ****to be perfectly/completely honest — 說真的；非常坦白地說****

Stronger than plain ****to be honest****.

Practice 1

> ****To be perfectly honest****, I don't understand the decision.

****說真的 / 非常坦白地說****，我不明白這個決定。

Practice 2

> ****To be completely honest****, I was disappointed.

****坦白說****，我很失望。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****to be perfectly/completely honest = 強調接下來的話是真實而完全坦率的個人看法****

13. ****honestly! (表示惱怒 / 難以置信) — 真是的！****

This is a very different conversational use, especially BrE.

Practice 1

> ****Honestly!**** Can't you be quiet for five minutes?

****真是的！****你就不能安靜五分鐘嗎？

Practice 2

> Oh, ****honestly****, what a mess!

唉，****真是的****，亂成這樣！

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****honestly! = 用來表達不耐煩、惱怒或難以置信****

Register: conversational.

14. **honestly?** — 真的嗎？你說真的？

Tone can turn **honestly** into a reaction of surprise.

Practice 1

> “I've never seen that film.”

> **Honestly?**”

「我從沒看過那部電影。」

「**真的嗎？**」

Practice 2

> **Honestly?** You finished all of that already?

真的？你已經全部完成了？

MCQ-ready definition:

honestly? = 表達驚訝並確認對方是否真的如此

15. **in all honesty** — 說實話；坦白說

Slightly more formal.

Practice 1

> **In all honesty**, we weren't ready.

說實話，我們當時還沒有準備好。

Practice 2

> **In all honesty**, I expected a better result.

坦白說，我本來預期結果會更好。

MCQ-ready definition:

in all honesty = 坦白、如實地說出自己的真實看法

16. **honest with yourself — 誠實面對自己**

Practice 1

> You need to **be honest with yourself** about what you really want.

你需要**誠實面對自己**，想清楚自己真正想要甚麼。

Practice 2

> She finally became **honest with herself** about how unhappy she was.

她終於**坦誠面對自己的感受**，承認自己其實很不快樂。

MCQ-ready definition:

be honest with yourself = 不自我欺騙，願意承認自己真正的想法、感受或處境

17. **honesty — 誠實；坦誠**

Practice 1

> I value **honesty** in a friendship.

我很重視友誼中的**誠實**。

Practice 2

> Thank you for your **honesty**.

謝謝你的**坦誠**。

MCQ-ready definition:

honesty = 說真話、不欺騙、願意坦白的品格或行為

18. **honesty about something — 對某事的坦率**

Practice 1

> Her **honesty about her mistakes** impressed me.

她對自己的錯誤如此**坦率**，令我印象深刻。

Practice 2

> We appreciated his **honesty about the difficulties**.

我們很欣賞他對困難的**坦誠**。

MCQ-ready definition:

honesty about something = 對某項事實或問題不隱瞞、坦白面對的態度

19. **dishonest — 不誠實的；欺騙的**

Practice 1

> It was **dishonest** of him to hide the truth.

他隱瞞真相是很**不誠實的**。

Practice 2

> The company was accused of **dishonest business practices**.

該公司被指採取**不誠實的商業手法**。

MCQ-ready definition:

dishonest = 故意欺騙、隱瞞真相或以不正當方式行事的

20. **dishonesty — 不誠實；欺騙行為**

Practice 1

> His **dishonesty** destroyed their trust.

他的**不誠實**破壞了彼此的信任。

Practice 2

> Academic **dishonesty** can lead to serious consequences.

學術上的**不誠實行為**可能帶來嚴重後果。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****dishonesty = 欺騙、說謊或不坦白的行為或特質****

21. ****an honest day's work — 踏實工作一天；正當勞動****

A traditional fixed expression.

Practice 1

> He believes in doing ****an honest day's work****.

他相信應該****踏踏實實工作一天****。

Practice 2

> There's nothing wrong with ****an honest day's work****.

靠****正當踏實的工作****生活沒有甚麼不好。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****an honest day's work = 認真、正當地完成一天應做的工作****

Important distinction 1: ****honest vs truthful****

Very close, but not identical.

****truthful****

specifically means statements are true.

> a ****truthful answer****

真實的回答

****honest****

broader:

* does not lie

* does not cheat

* acts fairly

* speaks sincerely

> an **honest person**

誠實的人

So a person is usually described as **honest**, not merely truthful.

Important distinction 2: **honest vs sincere**

honest

focuses on truth and lack of deception.

sincere

focuses on genuinely meaning what you say or feel.

> an **honest answer**

真實、不欺騙的回答

> a **sincere apology**

真誠的道歉

A statement can be sincerely believed but factually wrong.

Important distinction 3: **honest vs frank**

honest

truthful.

frank

open and direct, even when the truth may be uncomfortable.

> Let me be **frank**.

讓我直說吧。

So **frank** emphasizes directness more strongly.

Important distinction 4: **honest vs open**

honest

not deceptive.

open

willing to share information and feelings.

Someone may be honest when asked but still be private and not very open.

Important distinction 5: **honest vs trustworthy**

This connects nicely with your earlier **trust** entry.

honest

describes truthfulness and lack of cheating.

trustworthy

means deserving trust more broadly.

A trustworthy person is usually honest, but **trustworthy** can also include:

- * reliability
- * discretion
- * responsibility

Important distinction 6: **honestly think vs think honestly**

This is subtle but important.

I honestly think X

= I **genuinely** think X.

The adverb comments on the sincerity of the belief.

think honestly

unusual, but could mean trying to think without self-deception.

So your sentence uses the first structure:

> **honestly think** = 真心認為

Important distinction 7: **honestly vs actually**

They can sometimes both be translated 「真的」, but they differ.

honestly

emphasizes sincerity:

> I **honestly think** he's talented.

我真心認為他有天分。

actually

often corrects expectations or states a fact:

> He's **actually** only eight.

他其實只有八歲。

So **honestly ≠ actually**.

Important distinction 8: **honestly vs genuinely**

In your passage, they are close.

> I **honestly think** ...

> I **genuinely think** ...

Both can mean **我真心認為.....**

But **honestly** keeps a stronger connection to the speaker's truthfulness/sincerity, while **genuinely** emphasizes authenticity.

Important distinction 9: **to be honest** vs **honestly**

Both can introduce sincere opinion:

> **To be honest**, I don't like it.

> I **honestly** don't like it.

But **to be honest** functions as a discourse marker, while **honestly** directly modifies the clause/verb.

Important distinction 10: **honest mistake** vs **careless mistake**

honest mistake

focuses on lack of bad intention.

careless mistake

focuses on insufficient care.

A mistake can actually be **both**:

> It was an honest but careless mistake.

It was not deliberate, but it happened because someone was careless.

Important distinction 11: **honest work** vs **hard work**

honest work

legitimate / not dishonest.

hard work

requires a lot of effort.

So:

> honest work ≠ necessarily difficult work.

Important distinction 12: **honesty vs openness**

honesty

truthfulness.

openness

willingness to share and consider things.

A person can be honest but reserved; open but not necessarily accurate.

Family-extension note

Honest has a fairly compact semantic core:

truthful, sincere, and not deceptive

Its modern branches mainly develop through what exactly is being evaluated:

1. **person**

- * honest person

2. **communication**

- * honest answer
- * honest opinion
- * honest feedback

3. **conduct**

- * honest work
- * honest living

4. **lack of bad intent**

- * honest mistake

5. **stance/discourse**

- * honestly think
- * to be honest
- * in all honesty

The passage uses an especially important learner extension:

honestly + think/believe

Here, **honestly** means **genuinely / sincerely**, not merely 「沒有說謊地」.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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honest person	誠實的人	truthful character
honest with someone	對某人坦白	no deception
honest about X	坦白談及 X	truthful disclosure
honest answer	誠實 / 真實回答	truthful response
honest opinion	真實意見	genuine view
honest feedback	坦率意見	truthful evaluation
honest mistake	無心之失	no bad intention
honest work	正當工作	legitimate conduct
honest living	正當謀生	lawful livelihood
honest price/deal	公道價格 / 交易	fair, non-deceptive
honestly	誠實地	truthfully
honestly think	真心認為	genuinely believe
to be honest	老實說 ; 坦白說	introduce candid opinion
honestly!	真是的 !	irritation/disbelief
in all honesty	說實話	candid framing
honest with yourself	誠實面對自己	avoid self-deception
honesty	誠實 ; 坦率	quality of truthfulness
dishonest	不誠實的	deceptive
dishonesty	不誠實 ; 欺騙	deceptive conduct

For your original sentence

> Looking ahead, I **honestly think** he will grow into a very creative person.

Here:

honestly = 真心地；真的；確實地

It emphasizes the **sincerity of the speaker's prediction**.

The speaker is effectively saying:

> **This isn't just something nice I'm saying about Leo—I genuinely believe it.**

So a natural Traditional Chinese translation is:

> 展望未來，我**真的覺得**他會成長為一個很有創意的人。

or slightly stronger:

> 展望未來，我**真心認為**他將來會成為一個很有創意的人。

For this passage, **真心認為** captures the nuance especially well.